4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: January 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

January 2026 Locked January 2026 is locked (closed 3 Feb 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

January's jobs made $76,716 gross margin (41.9%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $22,372 and overheads $58,730, leaving ($4,386) profit before tax ((2.4%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 44.2% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$76,716
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$49,980
Technician time not charged to jobs	$22,372
Gross profit (the P&L)	$54,344
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$58,730
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($4,386)
Revenue	$183,306
Gross margin on jobs, %	41.9%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(2.4%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**44.2%**

Line: All

January against January last year
16.9%
$183,306 against $156,794

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$1,178,904
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
43.6%
$513,656 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is $1,178,904 this financial year to date (Jul to Jan 2026). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.8%); Installations the lowest (34.9%). The business needs 44.2% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 34.9% gross margin, 0.1 points under the 35.0% target: about $1,006 on $726,200 of revenue this financial year to date. It's below the 44.2% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($78,398 ahead on $272,000 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

January against January last year
45.0%
$40,100 against $27,650

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$272,000
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
63.8%
$173,598 before overheads

What it shows
Maintenance contracts brought in $272,000 this financial year to date, at a 63.8% gross margin (above the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($78,398 ahead on $272,000 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

January against January last year
9.0%
$109,100 against $100,100

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$726,200
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
34.9%
$253,164 before overheads

What it shows
Installations brought in $726,200 this financial year to date, at a 34.9% gross margin (below the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Installations: 34.9% gross margin, 0.1 points under the 35.0% target: about $1,006 on $726,200 of revenue this financial year to date. It's below the 44.2% needed to cover overheads, too.

Line: Call-outs and repairs

January against January last year
17.4%
$34,106 against $29,044

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$180,704
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
48.1%
$86,894 before overheads

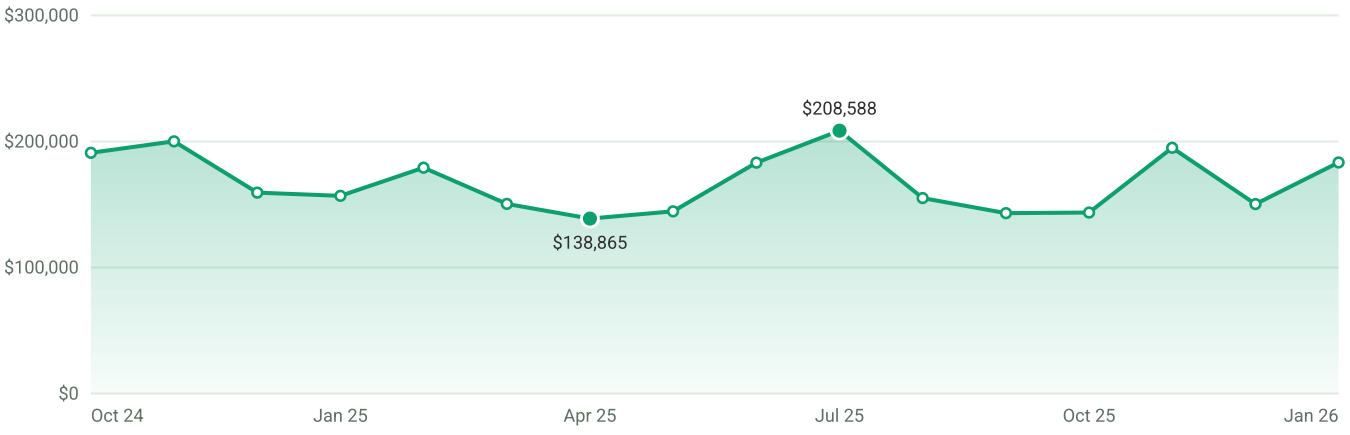
What it shows
Call-outs and repairs brought in $180,704 this financial year to date, at a 48.1% gross margin (above the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Call-outs and repairs: 48.1% gross margin, 13.1 points over the 35.0% target ($23,648 ahead on $180,704 this financial year to date).

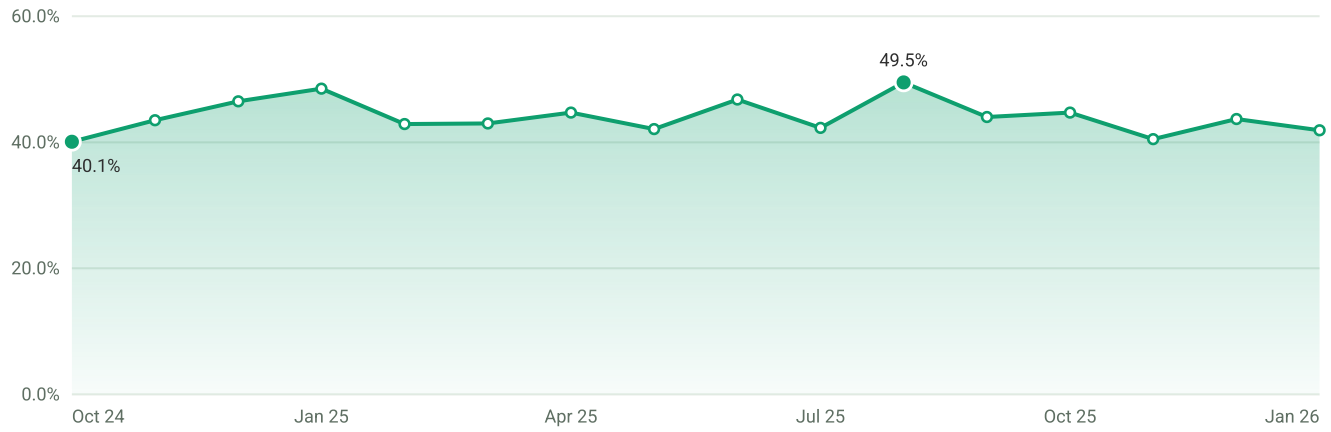
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Jan 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$272,000	–	–	$173,598	63.8%
Installations	$726,200	–	–	$253,164	34.9%
Call-outs and repairs	$180,704	–	–	$86,894	48.1%
Total	$1,178,904	–	–	$513,656	43.6%

Same period last year: Not available: the data starts October 2024.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.